



The Guardians are the Avengers of the 31st century.

GUARDIANS of the GALAXY

IN A POSSIBLE FUTURE, an alien race called the Badoon invaded our solar system in the 31st century and a team of adventurers banded together to oppose them. The Guardians were made up of the mysterious Starhawk, the super-strong Charlie-27, the silicon-based Marinex, the agile Nikki, Yondu the archer and Vance Astro, an American astronaut awakened after ages in suspended animation.



The Korvac Saga
Cyborg Michael Korvac was a computer genius who worked for the Badoon. He gained vast power from an alien ship and traveled back in time to reshape the universe. The Guardians joined with the Avengers to stop him.



Many Avengers were severely injured during the battle, but Korvac was eventually defeated.

HENRY GYRICH

HENRY PETER GYRICH does everything by the book. An agent for the National Security Council, he was assigned to investigate reports of "irregularities" concerning the Avengers. He entered the Mansion through a gaping hole in the side of the building, caused by a recent battle with Count Nefaria.

The Bean-Counter

Threatening to cancel the Avengers' special privileges—access to classified intelligence and exemption from air-traffic controls—Gyrich instituted stringent new policies on security. He also decided who was and who wasn't qualified to join the team's new roster.



Falcon was not pleased to learn that he was asked to join the Avengers because Gyrich had insisted that the team provide equal opportunities for minorities.

The S.H.I.E.L.D. Helicarrier is a huge airborne command base.

S.H.I.E.L.D.

THE SUPREME Headquarters International Espionage Law-enforcement Division is a worldwide intelligence and peace-keeping force that answers to the United Nations Security Council. It is dedicated to protecting the nations of Earth from global and extraterrestrial threats and has offices in many of the world's major cities.

Agent Programs

S.H.I.E.L.D. exchanges intelligence with the Fantastic Four and the Avengers. It has tried to enlist Captain America and Black Widow as full-time agents and has sent them on many freelance assignments. S.H.I.E.L.D. has also instituted programs to train super-agents, such as Quasar.

WEAPON SYSTEMS

Some of S.H.I.E.L.D.'s greatest assets are its advanced weaponry and sophisticated technology, most of which was designed by Tony Stark and built by Stark Industries.



Shifting Agendas

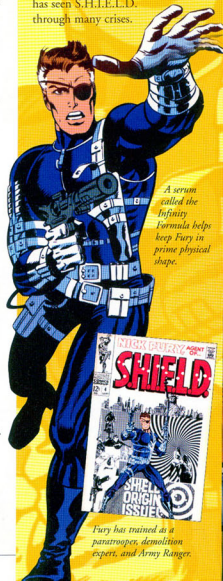
Although the Avengers and S.H.I.E.L.D. often work together, they have also come into conflict on occasion. When the Kree/Skrull War started to heat up, the U.S. government appointed an Alien Activities Commission that ordered S.H.I.E.L.D. to arrest the Avengers for harboring extraterrestrials. However, S.H.I.E.L.D. later made amends by lending the team a spacecraft.

THE MANDROIDS

S.H.I.E.L.D.'s Mandroid armor is for use against superhuman opponents. The suit gives superhuman strength and is equipped with stun cannons, lasers, and a tractor beam that can freeze or repel.

Nick Fury

The director of S.H.I.E.L.D. is a former soldier who once led a squad called the Howling Commandos. He rose to the rank of Colonel before leaving the military to become a C.I.A. agent. He accepted the directorship with the understanding that he would have authority over all field missions. Fury is gruff and decisive, but his personal integrity has seen S.H.I.E.L.D. through many crises.



A serum gained the Infinity Formula helps keep Fury in prime physical shape.



Fury has trained as a paratrooper, demolition expert, and Army Ranger.